

Tobin Hanspal, PhD

Curriculum Vitae updated August 30, 2026

CONTACT INFORMATION

Institute for Finance, Banking and Insurance
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A-1020 Vienna
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Citizenship: United States

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

07/2024 -	Associate Professor (with Tenure) Department of Finance, WU Vienna
08/2026 -	Network Member CEPR Household Finance Research Policy Network
04/2020 -	Research Affiliate Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE
09/2024 -	Faculty VGSF (Vienna Graduate School of Finance)
10/2019 - 09/2024	Affiliated Faculty VGSF (Vienna Graduate School of Finance)
09/2019 - 06/2024	Assistant Professor (Tenure Track) Department of Finance, WU Vienna
11/2016 - 08/2019	Post Doctoral Researcher Research Center SAFE, Goethe University Frankfurt

EDUCATION

11/2023	Habilitation in Finance (Venia docendi) <i>"Households' Experiences and Investment Choices"</i> Department of Finance, WU Vienna
10/2012 - 02/2017	Copenhagen Business School, Frederiksberg, DK. Department of Economics Ph.D. Economics: <i>Essays in Household Finance</i> Advisor: Steffen Andersen
11/2014 - 04/2015	University of Munich, DE. Department of Economics Visiting Ph.D. Student
10/2010 - 06/2012	Charles University, Prague, CZ. Masters (Mgr.) Economics and Political Studies
09/2001 - 06/2005	Bentley University, Waltham, MA, USA. BSc Marketing and Business

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Retail Investors, Behavioral Finance, Household Finance

RESEARCH IMPACT

[Google Scholar](#): Citations: 1100
h-index: 11
as of August, 2026

PUBLICATIONS

9. Balakina, O., Bäckman, C., Hackethal, A., Hanspal, T., & Lammer, D. M. (2026). [Personal Financial Advice and Portfolio Quality](#). *Review of Finance*. *WU Star Journal
8. Bräuer, K., Hackethal, A., Hanspal, T. & Hartzmark M. S., (2025). [Educating Investors about Dividends](#). *SAFE Working Paper No. 420*. Forthcoming *Review of Financial Studies*. *WU Star Journal
7. Bäckman, C., & Hanspal, T. (2022). [Participation and Losses in Multi-Level Marketing: Evidence from an FTC Settlement](#). *Financial Planning Review*, 5(1), e1137.
6. Bu, D., Hanspal, T., & Liao, Y. (2022). [Political Corruption, Trust, and Household Stock Market Participation](#). *Journal of Banking and Finance*, 138, 106442.
5. Bräuer, K., Hackethal, A., & Hanspal, T. (2022). [Consuming Dividends](#). *The Review of Financial Studies*, 35(10), 4802-4857. *WU Star Journal
4. Hackethal, A., Hanspal, T., Lammer, D. M., & Rink, K. (2022). [The Characteristics and Portfolio Behavior of Bitcoin Investors: Evidence from Indirect Cryptocurrency Investments](#). *Review of Finance*, Volume 26, Issue 4, July 2022, Pages 855-898. *WU Star Journal
3. Bu, D., Hanspal, T., Liao, Y., & Liu, Y. (2022). [Cultivating Self-Control in FinTech: Evidence from a Field Experiment on Online Consumer Borrowing](#). *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*, 57(6), 2208-2250.
2. Hanspal, T., Weber, A., & Wohlfart, J. (2021). [Exposure to the COVID-19 Stock Market Crash and its Effect on Household Expectations](#). *The Review of Economics and Statistics*, 103(5), 994-1010. *WU Star Journal
1. Andersen, S., Hanspal, T., & Nielsen, K. M. (2019). [Once Bitten, Twice Shy: The Power of Personal Experiences in Risk Taking](#). *Journal of Financial Economics*, 132(3), 97-117. *WU Star Journal

WORKING PAPERS

8. Fattinger, F., Hanspal, T., Koval B., & Steshkova, A. (2026). Binary Bias and Stock Returns.
7. Hanspal, T., & Wagner, C. (2023). [Local Returns and Beliefs about the Stock Market](#).
6. Kormanyos, K., Hanspal, T. & Hackethal, A., (2023). [Do Gamblers Invest in Lottery Stocks?](#) *SAFE Working Paper No. 373*. Reject and Resubmit *Management Science*. *WU Star Journal
5. Andersen, S., Hanspal, T., Martinez-Correa, J., & Nielsen, K. M. (2020). [Beliefs and the Disposition Effect](#).
4. Bu, D., Hanspal, T., Liao, Y., & Liu, Y. (2020). [Risk Taking, Preferences, and Beliefs: Evidence from Wuhan](#).
3. Andersen, S., Hanspal, T., & Nielsen, K. M. (2019). Do Financial Misconduct Experiences Spur White-Collar Crime?
2. Becker, G., Hanspal, T. (2018). Does Financial Technology Affect Household Savings Behavior. Revise and Resubmit *Journal of Banking and Finance*.

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| OTHER
PUBLICATIONS | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 1. Hanspal, T. (2018). The Effect of Personal Financing Disruptions on Entrepreneurship. <i>SAFE Working Paper No. 161</i>. 2. Bu, D., Hanspal, T., Liao, Y., & Liu, Y. (2020). Risk taking during a global crisis: Evidence from Wuhan. <i>Covid Economics</i>, 5, 106–146. 1. Bäckman, C., & Hanspal, T. (2018). Multi-Level Marketing Participation and Social Connectivity. <i>TFI Research Challenge Report</i>. |
| INVITED
PRESENTATIONS
AND CONFERENCES | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 2026 SGF 2026 (discussion), St. Gallen Financial Economics Workshop, Helsinki Finance Summit, EFA 2026 (discussion), CEPR European Conference on Household Finance 2026 (discussion) 2025 SGF 2025 (discussion), EFA 2025 (discussion) Queen Mary University 2024 AFA (discussion), University of St. Gallen, SGF Conference, University of Bremen, Deutsche Bundesbank, University of Mannheim 2023 Tilburg Finance, SGF Conference (discussion), EFA 2023, DGF 2023, 38th Austrian Working Group on Banking and Finance 2022 SGF Conference, CEPR Advanced Forum for Financial Economics (CAFFE), JEF Virtual Seminar, SAFE Household Finance Workshop, EDHEC Nice, Aalto University 2021 Renmin University of China, DGF German Finance Association (accepted but could not attend), FMA, SFS Cavalcade, JEF Virtual Seminar, NoEG, Bundesbank Household Finance Meeting, University of Bremen, MFA Chicago (discussant) 2020 Suffolk University, EFA, Finance in the Cloud III, Virtual Finance and Economics Conference, NoEG (Austrian Association of Economics), Economics Science Association, Society of Behavioral Economics, University of St. Gallen, Aarhus University, SKEMA Business School 2019 WU Vienna, Johannes Kepler University Linz, Innsbruck Winter Summit on Unethical Behavior in Markets, 5th European Retail Investment Conference (ERIC), Stockholm University, SKEMA Business School Fintech & Digital Finance Conference, TU Munich, Helsinki Finance Summit, European Finance Association (EFA), University of Passau 2018 American Finance Association (AFA), Swiss Finance Association (SGF), Lund University, University of Basel, University of Munich, EFA Warsaw (discussion), RBFC 2018, German Finance Association (DGF), 3rd SAFE Household Finance, SEA 2018, University of St. Gallen, Workshop on Sustainable Architecture for Finance 2017 2nd SAFE Household Finance Workshop, 2nd Entrepreneurial Finance Conference, Queensland UST, Swiss Finance Association (SGF) 2016 University of Münster, 1st SAFE Household Finance Workshop, European Economic Association, EBE Summer Meeting Munich, Queen's Management School Department of Finance, Goethe University Frankfurt, CEPR European Workshop on Entrepreneurship Economics, 3rd ZEW Conference on the Dynamics of Entrepreneurship |
| AWARDS AND
FUNDING | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> - SIX Best Paper Award, SGF Conference 2024 - WU City of Wien Best Paper Award, 2023 (7,000 EUR) - WU Researcher of the Month (May 2023) |

- WU City of Wien Best Paper Award, 2022 (7,000 EUR)
- Endowment and partnership with Erste Bank group, 2020, 2021 (40,000 EUR)
- Winner of the Sturm & Drang Prize for the best publication by a young researcher of the Faculty of Economics and Business Administration, Frankfurt. 2018 (1,500 EUR)
- SAFE: (PI) Anticipation Effects in Macprudential Policies, 2018
- SAFE: (PI) Asset Class Participation and the Effect of Peers, 2018
- SAFE: (PI) Economic Opportunity and Multi-level Marketing, 2017
- SAFE: (Co-PI) The Consumption Response to Stock Market Wealth, 2017
- Think Forward Initiative (TFI): Social Capital and Multi-level Marketing, 2017 (5,000 EUR)
- Joachim Hertz Stiftung: Fellowship for Interdisciplinary Economics, 2017 (12,500 EUR)
- Otto Mondsted, 2016 (Travel grant)
- Christian og Ottilia Brosøns, 2014 (Travel grant)
- Oticon Fonden, 2014 (Travel grant)
- Otto Mondsted, 2014 (Travel grant)
- PhD Fellowship - Department of Economics, Copenhagen Business School, 2012-2015

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

WU Vienna:

Household Finance (VGSF PhD): WS2022, WS2024 [scheduled]
 Advanced Topics in Finance (DigEcon Masters): WS2022, WS2023, WS2024 [scheduled]
 Behavioral Finance (WU Executive Academy MBA): 2020, 2021
 Behavioral Finance (FiRE Masters): SS2020, SS2021
 Behavioral Finance (Bachelors): SS2020, SS2021, SS2023, SS2024, WS2024, SS2025 [scheduled]
 Asset Management (Bachelors): SS2024, SS2025 [scheduled]
 Active Portfolio Management II (FiRE Masters): WS2019, WS2020, WS2021
 Executive MBA Thesis Supervision: 2020, 2021
 Masters Thesis Supervision: 2019-
 Bachelor Thesis Supervision: 2019-

Goethe University Frankfurt:

Research Topics in Finance (PhD Course): 2018-2019
 Personal Finance Seminar (Masters): 2016-2019
 Consumer Finance and FinTech Seminar (Bachelors): 2016-2017
 Masters Thesis Supervision: 2016-2019
 Bachelor Thesis Supervision: 2016-2019

Copenhagen Business School:

Guest Lecturer: Behavioral Economics (Masters): 2014
 Teaching Assistant: Microeconomics (Bachelors): 2013-2015

SERVICE	Ad hoc referee for	<i>Journal of Finance, Review of Financial Studies, Review of Finance, Management Science, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Journal of Corporate Finance, European Economic Review, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, The Economic Journal, PLOS One, European Financial Management, Journal of Banking and Finance, Journal of Economic Psychology, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Review of Behavioral Finance, etc.</i>
		Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG), German Economics Association (VfS) (2021), Midwest Finance Association (MFA) conference (2021), Swiss Finance Association (SGF) conferences (2018-), SMYE conferences (2016-20)
	<u>Committee service:</u>	
	Dissertation	Ceyda Üstün (Central European University), 2023
		Matthias Reiner (WU Vienna), 2026
	Internal: Teaching	Melis Kartal, PhD (WU Vienna), 2023
	Internal: Teaching	Finance lead for 'Digital Economy' Masters Program
	Internal: Recruitment	Lead junior recruiting job market search 2024-25, 2025-26, 2026-27
SELECTED MEDIA	Internal: Recruitment	Lead RA recruiting 2022, 2023, 2024
	September 2024	Multi-level Marketing, interview for Hashtag Media documentary: “Undercover: Was steckt hinter dem Hype des Network-Marketing?”
	Feb 2024	Consuming Dividends, La Presse: “Les dividendes ajoutent-ils une plus-value?”
	Dec 2023	Multi-level Marketing, interview for article in Der Standard, Portfolio
	May 2023	Interviewed for Bloomberg feature: “Tales from the Crypto Winter”
	February 2023	Do Gamblers Invest in Lottery Stocks: Featured article in FAZ
	August 2022	Personal Recommendations and Portfolio Quality: Featured blog post in Duke Financial Economics Center: FinReg Blog
	July 2022	Personal Recommendations and Portfolio Quality: Featured article in FAZ
	June 2022	Cryptocurrency interview on Rational Reminder podcast Episode 4
	May 2022	Consuming Dividends: Episode 201 Rational Reminder podcast
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	April 2022	Consuming Dividends: Episode 195 Rational Reminder podcast
	06/2006 - 10/2010	Ogilvy & Mather - Neo@Ogilvy: Worldwide Advertising Consultancy Associate Director of Client Strategy - <i>Financial services</i>
PERSONAL	US Citizen	
	Married (2020)	
	2 Children (2021, 2024)	
	1 Cattle Dog (2020)	